

CONTENT, PERSONAL BRAND & ADS · HOMEWORK

I let real founders write Kasim's ads.

The offer is Pareto Talent's Right Hand Program, Kasim's company. Every persona, angle and hook below starts from a real founder's words or a live competitor ad, not from my imagination.

Sources: 182 word-for-word founder quotes (Trustpilot, Indie Hackers, podcasts, founder blogs), plus Meta Ad Library and Google Ads Transparency checked for 9 advertisers on Oct 4, 2026.

What the ads sell: the first click is a free tool, **The 40-Hour Handoff Plan** (my final-project lead magnet). The last click is a matching call.

WHAT THE HOMEWORK ASKED, AND WHERE IT IS

ASKED	DONE	PAGE
ICP layer for Kasim: 5 personas, by cause	One-paragraph ICP + 5 personas named after their trigger	2
At least 2 angles per persona	10 angles, each a different door into the same pain	3
3 strongest persona × angle, one per stage	ToF, MoF, BoF, picked with Pareto's Idea Test and Pareto Score	3
Full creative: hook, body, CTA, what it looks like	3 ads in Ivan's 6-part structure, with image and video direction	4-5, 8
Ad campaign plan	Audiences, budget, kill rules, tracking	5
A couple of creatives per combination	8 ads to launch: 3 hooks for ToF, 2 for MoF and BoF, a video vs. image test, 3 test rounds	6
5 real competitors and their ad strategy	BELAY, Athena, Somewhere, Virtual Latinos, Prialto, plus Pareto's own live ads	7

1 • Who we're talking to

ICP, IN ONE PARAGRAPH

Founders of service businesses (agencies, law firms, consultancies, coaching companies) doing **\$100K+ a month**, who are **personally the bottleneck**: every client, decision and approval still goes through them. The founder decides and the founder pays.

5 PERSONAS, BY CAUSE (WHAT TRIGGERS THEM), NOT BY AGE OR INDUSTRY

PERSONA	THE TRIGGER	IN THEIR WORDS	WHAT STOPS THEM
1 • The Ceiling	Everything routes through them. Growth stops where their calendar stops.	"growth stalls at exactly the ceiling of what one person can personally touch"	"It's faster if I do it myself."
2 • The Burned	A VA or agency already failed, and they blame themselves.	"I keep thinking it was me until other staff and a second company brought time etc on and had the same experiences."	Paying to fail twice.
3 • The Stacked Staff	They hired people, and managing them became the job.	"I've hired all the people but I still feel like a solo in my law firm because I'm still creating more work for me, not less work for me"	"Another hire is another person to manage."
4 • The Overpaying	Paying a premium EA brand and still checking every task.	"This is not high-leverage support. It is task execution that still requires close oversight"	Switching cost. "They're all the same."
5 • The Reluctant	Has the budget, not the picture: doesn't know what to hand off.	"The first month of hiring my Belay assistant, I didn't know what tasks to give them. It was awkward."	"Is my work even worth an assistant?"

How I got them: I grouped the 182 quotes by what made the founder act, not by who they are. Two match personas Ivan shared in class: the agency owner whose VA failed (The Burned) and the 50-person firm that wants someone vetted and managed (The Stacked Staff).

Quotes: 1 Indie Hackers, indiehackers.com/post/from-indie-hacker-to-ceo-... · 2 Trustpilot review of Time Etc · 3 Davina Frederick, "Leadership in Law" podcast transcript (buzzsprout.com/2375350/16836375) · 4 Trustpilot review of Athena · 5 Bruce Ackerman (Printavo), bruceackerman.substack.com. Full list with URLs in my research file.

2 • Ten angles, three winners

TWO DOORS INTO THE SAME PAIN, PER PERSONA

PERSONA	ANGLE A	ANGLE B
1 • The Ceiling	"You're the ceiling." Growth stops at your calendar.	Calendar truth: your calendar says your priority is email.
2 • The Burned	"It wasn't you. It was the handoff."	1 in 1,000: selection, not luck.
3 • The Stacked Staff	Hire an owner, not a task-taker.	10 minutes a day with your Right Hand, not 10 hours.
4 • The Overpaying	Trained before day one: 40+ hours, AI tools included.	Guarantees in writing, price on the page.
5 • The Reluctant	Know what to hand off first, in 7 minutes.	Every founder who waited says the same: "far, far too late".

FILTER 1 • IDEA TEST (ONE MESSAGE, A REAL PAIN, BROAD APPEAL, A CURIOSITY HOOK)

6 of 10 passed. Out: 1B and 3B (two messages each), 2B and 4A (no loop opens).

FILTER 2 • PARETO SCORE, 0-3 PER FACTOR (16+ SHIPS, 12-15 REPAIR, 11 OR LESS BANK)

COMBINATION	VIEW	INTRIGUE	ICP	PAYOFF	PROVEN	PRE-SELL	BRAND	TOTAL
ToF • 5 Reluctant × 5A	3	2	3	3	2	2	3	18 • ship
MoF • 2 Burned × 2A	2	3	3	2	3	3	3	19 • ship
BoF • 1 Ceiling × 1A	2	2	3	2	2	3	3	17 • ship
4 Overpaying × 4B	1	2	2	1	2	3	2	13 • repair

Why these three: they walk one founder down the funnel. Reluctant founders learn *what* to hand off (ToF), burned founders learn *why* it failed last time (MoF), and the plan's own numbers make the matching call obvious (BoF).

Proven concept, not a guess: the MoF angle echoes Pareto's own live ad, "Why does every assistant I hire end up needing me more?" (Meta, Oct 2-3).

The repair: "The Overpaying" is too narrow for Meta. It becomes a Google search ad on "BELAY alternative", the same move Prialto makes today.

3 • The ads

TOF • COLD

5 RELUCTANT × KNOW WHAT TO HAND OFF

IMAGE 4:5

GOES TO: THE FREE PLAN

You're not bad at delegating. Nobody told you what to hand off first.

Most founders hire help, then stare at an empty task list. One founder put it plainly: "I didn't know what tasks to give them. It was awkward."

The 40-Hour Handoff Plan fixes that in 7 minutes:

1. Tick the tasks eating your week.
2. Get your first 30 days mapped, week by week.
3. Copy a ready-to-send brief for every task: what goes in, what comes out, what "done" looks like.

Built on the delegation method Pareto Talent uses with 100+ founders. Made for founders who still run their own inbox. Free.

Download

Headline: **Your first 30 days of delegation, mapped**

Looks like: a founder's week in a calendar, packed solid. Three blocks lift off the grid as cards labeled "Week 1". On-image text: "What do I hand off first?" Pareto's own look: near-black #050A0E, green #10B981, Plus Jakarta Sans. Real photo style, no stock smiles.

MOF • WARM

2 BURNED × IT WASN'T YOU

VIDEO 30S

GOES TO: THE FREE PLAN

Your last assistant didn't fail. Your handoff did.

0-3s Kasim to camera: "Your last assistant didn't fail. Your handoff did."

3-12s "Most first hires fail for one reason. You handed off the task, not the context. So they guess, you fix it, and you decide delegation doesn't work for you."

12-22s "The fix takes seven minutes. The 40-Hour Handoff Plan tells you what to hand off first and writes the brief for each task. It's the same Black Box method we use at Pareto."

22-30s "It's free. Build your plan before you hire again." On screen: **Pareto Right Hands stay: 93% are still with Pareto after 12 months.**

Download

Qualifier in the caption: "If you've hired an assistant and ended up doing the work twice, this is for you."

Looks like: Kasim talking head, natural light, captions burned in. B-roll: my Day 7 clip "A founder's week" (the calendar fills to 62 hours, then 22 of them slide away).

BOF · HOT

1 CEILING × YOU'RE THE CEILING

IMAGE 4:5

GOES TO: MATCHING CALL

You made the plan. Now hand it to someone who runs it.

Your Handoff Plan shows the work. A Pareto Right Hand does it: full-time, trained on AI tools before day one, chosen from 1,000+ applicants.

Freedom 40: attend the Mastermind, follow the onboarding plan, meet your Right Hand 10 minutes a day. If you don't get 40 hours back in your first 30 days, your next month is on us.

Answer 2 questions, take a short matching call, and get 3 hand-picked profiles within 24 hours. No contract until you find your person. For founders doing \$100K+ a month.

Book now

Proof line: 100+ founders served · 4.9★ on Google · 93% still with Pareto after 12 months

Looks like: the same calendar from the ToF ad, now with the founder's column half empty and a green "Right Hand" column full. On-image text: "40 hours back in 30 days. Or next month is free."

4 • Campaign plan

STAGE	AUDIENCE	BUDGET	SUCCESS SIGNAL
ToF	US, broad. Ivan's rule: default settings, the ad tells Meta who it's for	60%	CTR above 1%, cost per opt-in
MoF	50%+ video viewers and page visitors, 30 days, minus opt-ins	25%	Opt-in rate from warm traffic
BoF	Plan downloaders who didn't book, 14 days	15%	Cost per booked call

Budget: start at \$1,000 (Ivan's first-campaign rule), then read the numbers. At Pareto's US cost per click of \$3.80 (Ivan, Day 8), the ToF share buys about 158 clicks, enough to test the hook.

Kill rules: CTR under 1% after 1,000 impressions → swap in the next hook (page 6). Opt-ins but no bookings → fix the BoF ad, not the ToF.

Tracking: Meta Pixel + Conversions API (opt-in and booked call), GA4 through Tag Manager, one UTM per ad. The number that decides: LTV:CAC above 3:1.

5 • How the ads get tested

One ad per stage is a guess. Meta needs several creatives at once to find the winner, so each stage launches with hook variants. Same body, same offer, same visual: **only the first line changes**, so the result says which hook works.

AD SET	HOOK A (THE AD ON PAGE 4-5)	HOOK B	HOOK C
ToF 4 ads	"You're not bad at delegating. Nobody told you what to hand off first."	"Takes longer to explain it than to do it yourself? Not with a brief."	"Your first hire's first month, planned before day one."
MoF 2 ads	"Your last assistant didn't fail. Your handoff did."	"Delegated it. Checked it. Redid it. Again?"	Held back (see budget below)
BoF 2 ads	"You made the plan. Now hand it to someone who runs it."	"40 hours back in 30 days. Or next month is free."	Held back

Where the hooks come from: founders' own words in my research bank. B for ToF is the most common objection ("It'll take me longer to explain this task than to do it myself"), C is "I didn't know what tasks to give them", and the MoF B is "I'm having to check up because things aren't getting done the way I want". The words shape the hook; no founder is named or quoted in the ad.

THE 4TH TOF AD: SAME HOOK, OTHER FORMAT

ToF • image vs. video

Hook A on my Day 7 video clip "A founder's week" (the calendar fills to 62 hours, 22 slide away) against Hook A on the image. Answers: does motion stop the scroll better for cold founders?

Later, not now

MoF as a static (the "It wasn't you" image) and BoF as video (the Day 7 "1 in 1,000" clip) are ready, but they wait for round 2. Testing two things at once teaches nothing.

WHY 8 ADS, NOT 20

The budget decides the number of ads. \$1,000 at \$3.80 a click gives the ToF about 158 clicks. Split over 4 ads, each gets about 40, enough to compare clicks (CTR), not bookings. Warm and hot audiences are small (only people who saw a video or got the plan), so 2 ads each, or no ad gets enough reach to judge. More ads only make sense once the budget grows.

THREE ROUNDS, ONE QUESTION EACH

- Week 1 • Which hook?** Run all 8 (the 4th ToF ad also answers image vs. video for cold traffic). At 1,000 impressions per ad, turn off any ToF hook under 1% CTR. Keep the best one per stage.
- Week 2 • Which format?** The winning hook as image vs. video in MoF and BoF, plus 2 new ToF hooks written in the winner's style.
- Week 3 • Which offer line?** Only in BoF: Freedom 40 vs. "3 profiles in 24 hours". Judged on cost per booked call.

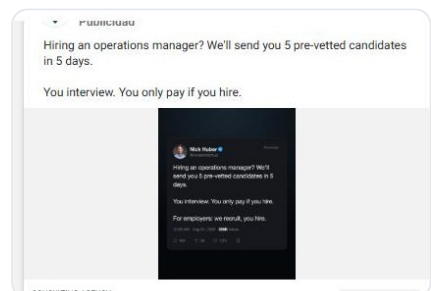
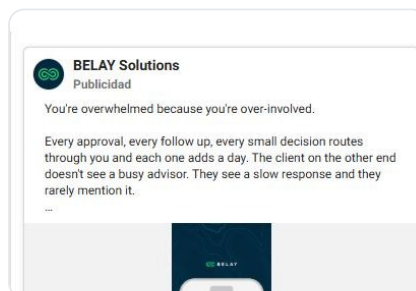
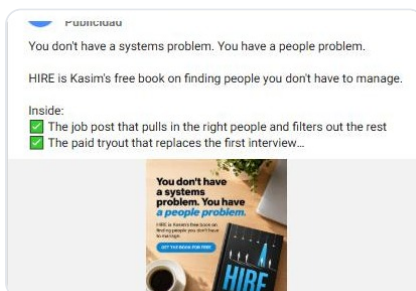
Naming, so the numbers stay readable: stage_persona_hook_format, e.g. *ToF_Reluctant_B_IMG*. The same name goes in the ad's UTM, so a booked call in the CRM shows which hook brought it.

6 · What the competitors are running

Checked live on Oct 4, 2026 in Meta Ad Library and Google Ads Transparency. Same customer as Pareto: founders hiring an EA.

COMPETITOR	WHERE THEY SPEND	OFFER & ANGLE	BEST LIVE HOOK	WHAT I TAKE / AVOID
BELAY	Meta ~66 ads (oldest Jul 8) · Google ~400	US-based EAs, rematch guarantee, a free guide per vertical, client stories	"Your best closer is stuck doing admin."	Take: one guide per niche. Avoid: an unclear premium ("the value proposition isn't clear", a BELAY review).
Athena	Google 77 (Search + YouTube) · no Meta	Elite full-time EA. A 10-question quiz gives a delegation level, then "find your match"	"Hand Off What You Hate Most"	Take: tool first, call second. Gap: a level tells you who you are, not what to do on Monday.
Somewhere	Meta ~9 (prospecting + retargeting) · Google 97	"5 pre-vetted candidates in 5 days. You only pay if you hire." Creator collab with Nick Huber	"Give the work a new owner"	Take: a retargeting sequence by role. Pareto's "3 profiles in 24 hours" beats their speed.
Virtual Latinos	Meta ~30 ads, only 3 copies · Google 64	Price and time: "Starting at \$1.6K/month", "Get your Saturdays back"	"Still working weekends?"	Avoid: "85% efficiency" claims with no proof, and a race on price.
Prialto	Google 2 · Meta 0	Managed VA with backup cover	"BELAY Solutions Alternative"	Take: competitor-alternative search ads. That's the home for persona 4.
Pareto (own)	Meta 25 ads (Oct 2-3) · Google 3	Kasim's free book HIRE: how to find people you don't have to manage	"Why does every assistant I hire end up needing me more?"	The Handoff Plan sits right after the book: HIRE says who to hire, the plan says what to hand them.

LIVE IN META AD LIBRARY, OCT 4: PARETO · BELAY · SOMEWHERE

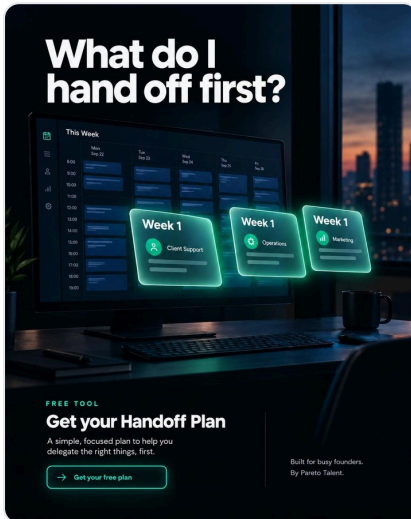


WHAT NOBODY RUNS ON META, SO PARETO CAN OWN IT

AI-trained talent as the message · a speed promise ("3 profiles in 24 hours") · a free tool that writes the founder's own plan.

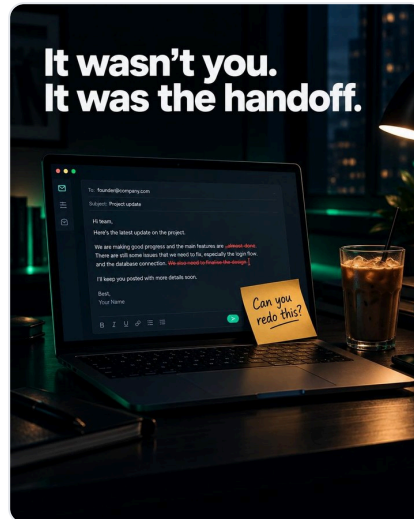
7 • The ads, rendered

Made the Day 7 way: a description of the scene, a style guide, and a screenshot of Pareto's real palette attached to every prompt. Then iterate one change at a time instead of regenerating.



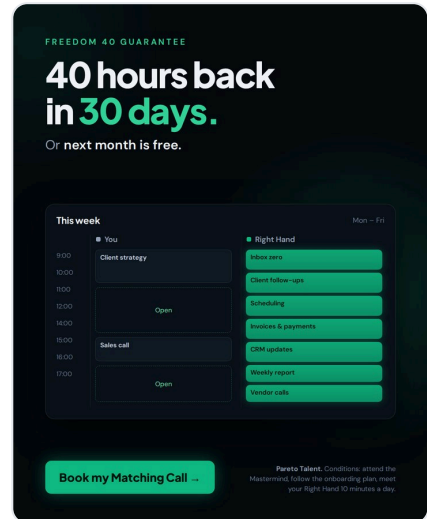
TOF • COLD

ChatGPT image. One iteration: the first take spelled "handoff", so I asked for that one change and kept everything else.



MOF • WARM

ChatGPT image. Static version and thumbnail of the 30-second video: the sticky note says what every burned founder heard.



BOF • HOT

Built in code with Pareto's real fonts and colors. A calendar is UI, so code renders it exactly, and the Freedom 40 conditions sit on the image.

THE TOF PROMPT, WITH THE STYLE GUIDE INLINED

Facebook ad image for a free delegation tool for busy founders. A founder's weekly calendar on a large monitor in a dark, modern office at dusk, packed solid with dark navy blocks. Three blocks lift off the screen and float forward as glowing glass cards labeled "Week 1". Top text in white bold sans: "What do I hand off first?" Style: premium, cinematic, near-black #050A0E, navy #0F1923, one accent, Pareto green #10B981. No stock smiles, no logos, no purple. 4:5. *[Pareto palette attached]*

One look across the funnel: the ads, the free plan, the landing page and the emails all use the same near-black and green, so a founder who clicks feels they're in the same place.